

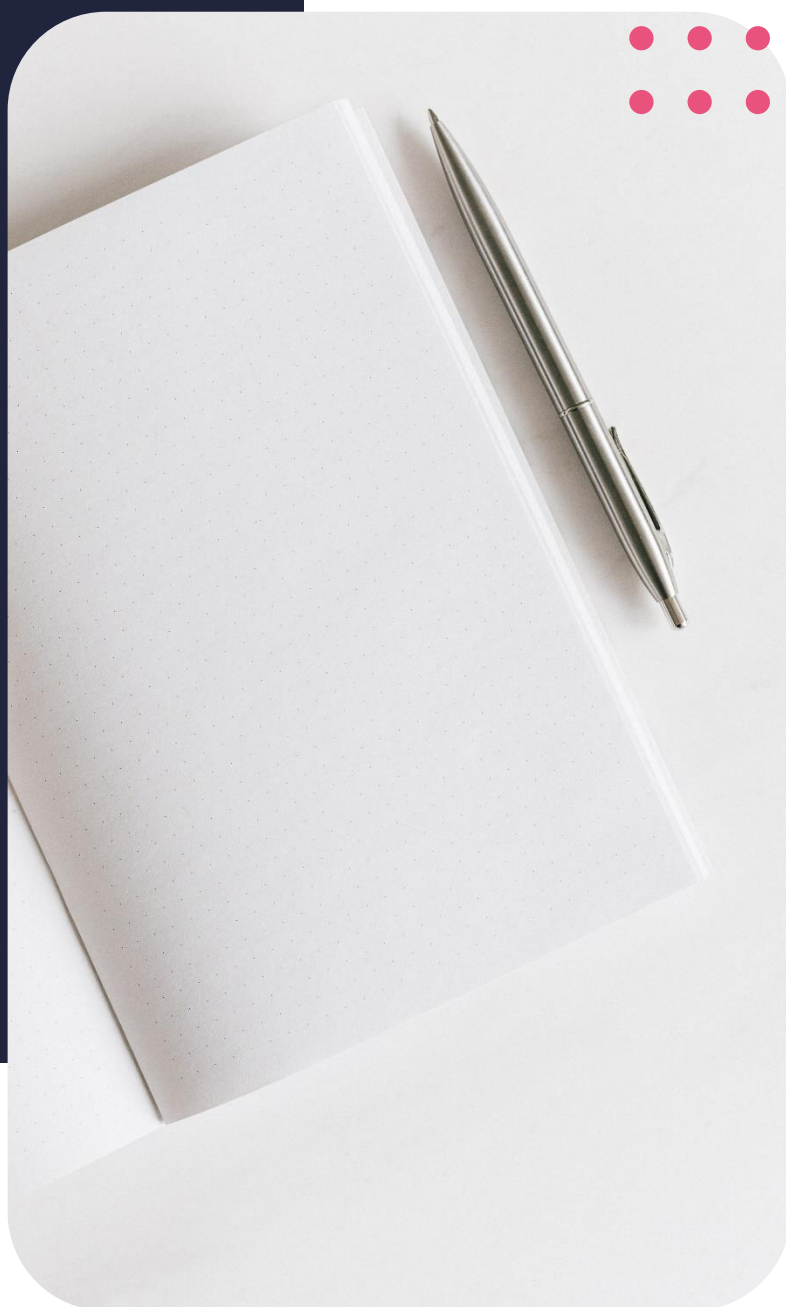
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Create a Healthy Company Culture



Contents

- 3 Lesson 6 Objectives
 - Introduction
 - Key Reading Materials
 - Assess your company culture
- 4 How to build a company culture
- 5 As an employee, how can you see if the company culture is correct for you?
 - Examples of companies with great company cultures
- 6 Vision Statement
 - Steps to write a good company vision statement
- 7 Examples of company vision statements
 - Mission
 - Elements that need to be in your mission statement
 - Examples of company missions
- 8 Bibliography



Lesson 6 Objectives

- Leadership and culture
- Value-based leadership
- Creating a vision and purpose

Lesson Introduction

The company culture is the heart of who your company is. We want companies to have a strong and healthy culture that inspires and empowers.

“We have a culture where we are incredibly self-critical, we don’t get comfortable with our success”.

– Mark Parker, CEO, Nike

Key Reading Materials

- <https://neilpatel.com/blog/great-company-culture/>
- <https://www.shrm.org/resourcesandtools/tools-and-samples/toolkits/pages/understandinganddevelopingorganizationalculture.aspx>
- <https://www.thebalancecareers.com/how-to-understand-your-current-culture-1918811>

Self-Assessment: Company Culture

- <https://www.inc.com/alison-davis/these-15-questions-will-assess-your-companys-culture-and-help-you-decide-how-to-improve-it.html>
- <https://www.achievers.com/blog/5-simple-ways-assess-company-culture/>

How to build a company culture

According to (Nathanson, 2018), here are the following steps to building a good company culture:

Step 1: Define what you want your company culture and values to look like

For example:

- Why does the company do the things they do?
- What are the values we deem important as a company and what do we want from our employees?
- Where do we see the company in the future?

Define the culture and the values that you want the company and employees to have based on who your company is and what they are or want to be.

Step 2: Evaluate your current company culture

This is a step for more established companies. You won't have a culture in place for a new company. Take the time to understand the current company culture and then set up a plan to change it to the new culture that you want to see in the company. You can look at the team culture, management culture and the culture in the board of directors.

Step 3: Identify or hire someone who advocates

You need to identify someone in the company who will drive the culture that you want to see in the company. The aim is to select someone that advocates for the culture and that really connects with the employees. This does not have to be an HR person. This can be someone that is an expert in HR or someone in your team that is able to invoke change.

Step 4: Invest in your talent brand

This means investing time and money in evaluating what your employees feel, think and share about the company. New recruits will look at the talent brand of the company before deciding to work for the brand. In order to attract the correct talent that fits your cultural needs, you need to fix your talent brand. Take the time to build your brand, for example, you can add a 'career' option on the company website. You can add your company values, the positions you have, and employee reviews.

Step 5: Recruitment

Update your recruitment process to reflect your company culture. When hiring new employees, ensure that they fit your company values. Update your interview process and questions to include culture questions. You can also prioritise attitude over skills.

Step 6: Measure your engagement

In order to see if the culture is working, a lot of companies take the time to measure the engagement of their employees. The engagement can include a check on employee ratings, reviews on sites like Glassdoor and many more. This gives the company insight into what the honest opinion of employees is.

As an employee, how can you see if the company culture is correct for you?

According to (Doyle, 2020), you can evaluate the company culture in the following ways:

Look at the company website

Look at the 'about us' page on the website. This will give you a lot of insight when it comes down to the company mission, vision and values. Make sure that the values are in line with yours. This way you are more likely to find the company as a cultural fit.

Do some research

There are a lot of review sites that you can visit to obtain honest feedback from past employees of the company. The employees can rate the company and outline the good and the bad of what they experienced working for the company, for example, www.glassdoor.com.

Ask around

You can look for stakeholders of the company to give feedback. You can speak to past employees, current employees, customers and many more. You can also use a website like LinkedIn to find employees of the company and ask some questions.

Ask the right questions during the interview

You can ask the company for an example of team building activities they have done, what flexibility they offer, what rewards process they have in place. You can also ask what leadership styles they make use of in the company.

Shadow someone

Before accepting the position, you can ask to shadow at the company. This way you can see more of how the company operates and if you're happy to work there.

Examples of companies with great company cultures:

According to (Patel, 2015), there are several companies that we all can learn from when it comes down to company cultures.

Here we have the following:

Zappos

"Zappos hires according to cultural fit first and foremost. It has established what the company culture is, and fitting into that culture is the most important thing managers look for when hiring. This promotes culture and happy employees, which ultimately leads to happy customers".

Warby Parker

"Warby Parker has made company culture deliberate by creating a dedicated team tasked with coming up with events and programs to promote community. Great company culture doesn't happen on its own".

Twitter

"You can't beat having team members who are pleasant and friendly to each other, and are both good at and love what they are doing. No program, activity or set of rules stop [us from] having happy and fulfilled employees who feel that what they are doing matters".

Google

"Even the best culture needs to revisit itself to meet a growing company's team. The most successful company culture leads to a successful business, and that requires an evolving culture that can grow with it".

Facebook

"When your company depends on new hires who excel in a competitive field, your company culture and any associated perks will likely be the tipping point for applicants. You must stand out from other companies vying for attention".

Vision Statement:

According to (Wright, 2019), "A vision statement is the anchor point of any strategic plan. It outlines what an organisation would like to ultimately achieve and gives purpose to the existence of the organisation. A good vision statement should be short, simple, specific to your business, leave nothing open to interpretation. It should also have some ambition".

Steps to writing a good company vision statement:

Step 1: Define what you do as an output

Example: "Microsoft famously had a vision statement to *Put a Microsoft powered computer on every desk in the world*"

Step 2: Define what is unique about what your company brings to the above outcome

Add what is unique or special about your company. For example, a bakery that has used a 100-year-old recipe will highlight that in their vision statement.

Step 3: Add some high-level quantification

Using the bakery again. You will add your quantification by saying: We will serve every customer in walking distance of the bakery or in that city. This way you are adding a qualification without being specific.

Step 4: add relatable, human, or real work aspect to your statement

For example, Microsoft can say that they want every person on Earth to use a Microsoft product or everyone that leaves our store should be happy.

Final example:

Using the bakery once more, here are all the steps combined: "Producing and selling locally sourced cakes and pies that are so delicious and satisfying, that every customer who leaves our store does so with a smile". (Wright, 2019)

Examples of company vision statements:

- Amazon: "To be Earth's most customer-centric company where customers can find and discover anything they might want to buy online".
- Ben & Jerry's: "Making the best ice cream in the nicest possible way".
- Caterpillar: "Our vision is a world in which all people's basic needs – such as shelter, clean water, sanitation, food and reliable power – are fulfilled in an environmentally sustainable way, and a company that improves the quality of the environment and the communities where we live and work".
- Google: "To provide access to the world's information in one click".

Mission

(Big Commerce, 2019) stated: "A well-crafted mission statement focuses the business for both employees and the target audience. It serves as a framework, giving everyone involved a launching point to build from when establishing the brand. For consumers, it sets the company apart from the competition without limiting the business purpose".

Elements that need to be in your mission statement

According to (Big Commerce, 2019), the following needs to be in any mission statement:

- Value – What is the value of the business to both customers and employees?
 - Inspiration – Why should people want to work for the company?
-

- Plausibility – Make it sound reasonable
- Specificity – Tie it back to the business

Examples of company missions

According to (Cherry, 2019), these are some great examples of company missions:

- Uber: We ignite opportunity by setting the world in motion.
- Google: To organize the world's information and make it universally accessible and useful.
- Kickstarter: To help bring creative projects to life.
- Tesla: To accelerate the world's transition to sustainable energy.
- Life is Good: To spread the power of optimism.
- Wawa: Fulfilling Lives, Every Day.
- Squarespace: Squarespace empowers people with creative ideas to succeed.

Bibliography

Big Commerce . (2019, July 23). *How to write a powerful mission statement that resonates*. Retrieved from Big Commerce : <https://www.bigcommerce.com/ecommerce-answers/how-to-write-a-powerful-effective-mission-statement/>

Doyle, A. (2020, January 19). *The Definition of Company Culture*. Retrieved from The balance careers : <https://www.thebalancecareers.com/what-is-company-culture-2062000>

Nathanson, E. (2018, June 25). *Building Company Culture: 7 Steps for Every Small Business*. Retrieved from LinkedIn: <https://business.linkedin.com/talent-solutions/blog/company-culture/2018/build-company-culture-small-business>

Patel, S. (2015, August 6). *10 Examples of Companies With Fantastic Cultures*. Retrieved from Entrepreneur : <https://www.entrepreneur.com/article/249174>

Wright, T. (2019, Jun 5). *How to Write a Good Vision Statement*. Retrieved from Cascade: <https://www.executestrategy.net/blog/write-good-vision-statement>